

Podcasting Kit

WHAT'S IN THE KIT

- 4 podcasting mic kits
- 4 mic stands
- Zoom PodTrak standalone recorder
- Rechargeable batteries + charger
- 64 GB SD card



QUICK-START GUIDE

1. Plug mics into the PodTrak's 4 inputs — it records without a computer.
2. Sound-check each speaker; watch the level meters.
3. Record to SD; each mic gets its own track.
4. Import to WeVideo or any editor for editing and music.
5. Quiet-ish room + the Sound Shield = surprisingly professional results.

FULL LESSONS IN THIS GUIDE

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PRO TIP: The PodTrak's separate tracks mean one loud kid can be turned down in the edit. Bless.

Podcasting Kit

LESSON · GRADES 3-5

Expert Interview Show

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will research a topic and prepare interview questions
- Students will conduct a structured spoken interview
- Students will summarize spoken content into a tight edit

MATERIALS

- Podcasting kit: mics, stands, PodTrak recorder
- Quiet recording corner (add the Sound Shield if available)
- Interview prep sheet: 5 questions, follow-up starters
- Episode intro/outro script frame

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Play a 2-minute kid-friendly podcast clip as the mentor text.
2. Pairs pick topics and split roles: host researches questions, expert researches answers.
3. Prep sheets complete before anyone touches a mic.
4. Record in the corner: intro, 5-question interview, outro — aim for one take.
5. Light edit: trim the big stumbles, keep the natural voice.
6. Listening party with a two-glows-one-grow feedback round.

ACTIVITY

Expert Interview Show — host and expert roles make research conversational. The one-take recording goal teaches preparation; the listening party makes the audience real.

Podcasting Kit

LESSON · GRADES 6-8

Serialized Class Podcast

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will produce recurring episodes on a production schedule
- Students will perform specialized production roles
- Students will refine craft through episode-over-episode iteration

MATERIALS

- Podcasting kit (4 mics + PodTrak)
- Role cards: host, engineer, editor, producer
- Episode planning template and release calendar
- Editing access (WeVideo or similar)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Launch meeting: the class names the show and picks segment formats (news, book talks, explainers).
2. Assign 4-person crews to episodes on a rotating calendar.
3. Producer runs the planning template; engineer owns levels and the PodTrak.
4. Record on schedule — the calendar creates real deadlines.
5. Editor cuts each episode; producer publishes to the class feed.
6. After each episode: 10-minute crew retro — one improvement for the next crew.

ACTIVITY

Serialized Class Podcast — a real show with rotating crews, deadlines, and episode retros. The craft improvement from episode 1 to episode 5 is visible, audible, and owned by students.

Podcasting Kit

LESSON · GRADES 9-12

Documentary Audio Storytelling

LEARNING OUTCOMES

- Students will construct a narrative audio story from interviews
- Students will apply journalistic ethics to sourcing and editing
- Students will design sound (music, ambience, pacing) to serve a story

MATERIALS

- Podcasting kit + Sound Shield
- Story pitch template: focus, sources, arc
- Interview consent basics one-pager
- Editing suite with music/ambience library (royalty-free)

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Study a short NPR-style piece: map its narration, interview clips, and sound design.
2. Story pitches: a real school or community story with identifiable interview sources.
3. Ethics brief: consent, accurate quoting, and what editing can't do to someone's words.
4. Field recording: interviews plus ambient sound from the story's world.
5. Structure the edit: narration bridges, best clips, silence as a tool.
6. Screening session with a professional-style critique: story, sound, ethics.

ACTIVITY

Documentary Audio Storytelling — real interviews shaped into an NPR-style narrative with intentional sound design. The ethics conversation around editing someone's words is the deepest lesson in the unit.